

Home activity pack, ages 3 to 7

The Spring That Wanted to Stay

Twelve pages to color, cut, trace, make and talk about, all from the story.
The value in this book: generosity.

For use in your own home. Please don't share the file or post it online.

For grown-ups

Read the story first, then pick one page a day. Each page takes 10 to 20 minutes. There are no wrong answers.

The big idea

When we share what we have, it doesn't run out. It keeps life flowing, for others and for us.

Say it together

Drip... drip... drip.

Five words from the story

Word	What it means	Do it
spring	a place where water bubbles up out of the ground	wiggle your fingers upward like bubbles
pond	a small pool of still water	make a round shape with your arms
flow	to move along like water in a stream	wave your hand forward
still	not moving at all	freeze like a statue
valley	low land between hills or mountains	make a V shape with your arms

A gentle note

Wanting to keep things is normal. Never shame a child for it; Nura is scared, not bad.

Sharing doesn't mean giving away everything until nothing is left. Nura becomes more, not less.

What you need

Crayons, a pencil, scissors, glue or tape, a few craft sticks or straws, and the book (or read it free on screen at doubleadventure.ca).

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

Meet the friends

Cut out each card along the dashed line. Tape a craft stick on the back and you have a puppet. Act out the story!



The otter family

Eurasian otters

Look for a swimming hole, then leap in when the water comes back



The heron

Grey heron

Comes back when the stream flows again



The bees

Buff-tailed bumblebees

Buzz from flower to flower



The frogs

Common frogs

Hop away when the pond grows still, and come back later

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

How did they feel?

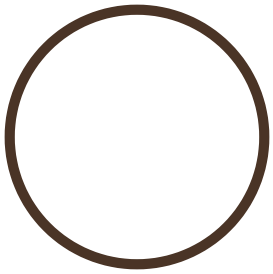
Feelings change during a story. Talk about each moment, then draw how the character felt.

Moment 1

Nura and Willo look after each other.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

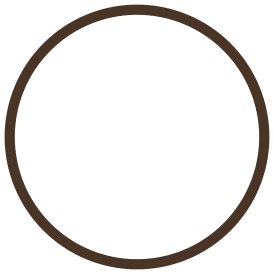


Moment 2

Willo droops; his birds fly away.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm

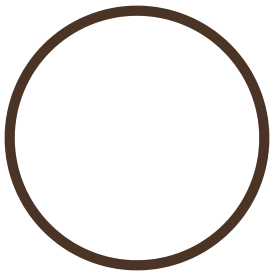


Moment 3

She becomes a river.

Draw the face. Then circle a word.

sad scared worried happy brave proud calm



© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

Story in order

Color the pictures. Write 1, 2 and 3 in the boxes to show what happened first, next and last. Then cut them out and tell the story.



Color me ☐



Color me ☐



Color me ☐

Tell it in your own words

First, _____

Then, _____

At the end, _____

For grown-ups: the pictures come from the start, the middle and the end of the book. Younger children can just point and tell.

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

Trace the words

Trace each word with a pencil. Then try writing it on your own in the empty space.

spring a place where water bubbles up out of the ground

spring spring

pond a small pool of still water

pond pond

flow to move along like water in a stream

flow flow

Nura the hero of the story

Nura Nura

Write your name

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

Draw your own story

Nura showed generosity. Draw a time when you showed generosity too, or a time you could.



Tell a grown-up: What happened? How did you feel? How did the other person feel?

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

Make and do

Pick one to try today. Each one comes straight from the story.

Stuck pond, flowing stream

You need: A tray, stones, a watering can, leaves

Build a stream on a tilted tray and pour water. Then block it with stones and pour again. Add leaves to the still water. Talk about which water stays fresh.

Pass the water

Fill a cup and pass it along a line of friends with a spoon each. Does everyone get some?

Heron statue

Stand on one leg like a heron. How long can you stay still?

Bee buzz

Hum with your lips closed and feel the buzz. That's how bees shake pollen loose!

Draw what you made

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

The real animals

The animals in The Spring That Wanted to Stay are based on real ones. Here is something true about each of them.



The otter family

Eurasian otters

A group of otters can be called a romp.



The heron

Grey heron

Even with huge wings, a heron weighs little more than a pheasant.



The bees

Buff-tailed bumblebees

If a flower is too deep, a bumblebee may bite a hole in the side and sip the nectar.



The frogs

Common frogs

It's the most widespread amphibian in Europe.

Story or real?

Real otters really do need rivers full of water and fish. A dry stream would be a real problem for an otter family.

Where they really live

Nura's mountain has no name, so we picked the Hohe Tauern National Park in the Austrian Alps. It's full of glaciers, springs and streams that melt and flow down to the valleys, just like Nura.

Facts and sources: doubleadventure.ca/heroes/the-spring-that-wanted-to-stay

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

Color the story

Color this page from the book. What is happening here?



© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca

Talk together cards

Cut out the cards and keep them in a jar. Pull one out at dinner, in the car or at bedtime.

Where does water come from? Where do you think it goes?

The Spring That Wanted to Stay, talk card 1

Why did Nura want to keep all her water?

The Spring That Wanted to Stay, talk card 2

What happened to the valley and to Willo when Nura stopped flowing?

The Spring That Wanted to Stay, talk card 3

Why do you think Nura felt empty even though she was so full?

The Spring That Wanted to Stay, talk card 4

What happened to Nura after she shared? Did she get smaller?

The Spring That Wanted to Stay, talk card 5

What is something you have that you could share? How might it come back to you?

The Spring That Wanted to Stay, talk card 6

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca



Generosity hero

This is to say that

_____

showed generosity, just like Nura.

Drip... drip... drip.

Signed _____ Date _____

© A² Publishing, doubleadventure.ca